

At a Farewell,
Trump's D.C.
Is on Display

A President's Arc, From
McCain to Graham

By PETER BAKER

WASHINGTON — When the first of the Three Amigos died, the service at Washington National Cathedral felt like a repudiation of President Trump, who was not invited and not welcome. When the last of the amigos departed this life, the service felt like an affirmation of Mr. Trump, who was not only invited but led the tributes.

From John McCain to Lindsey Graham, two members of a trio of senators once so close that they compared their friendship to a marriage, the stark difference between two services in the same majestic cathedral eight years and worlds apart exemplified how much has changed in the nation's capital. It may not have been Donald Trump's Washington in 2018 but it most assuredly is in 2026.

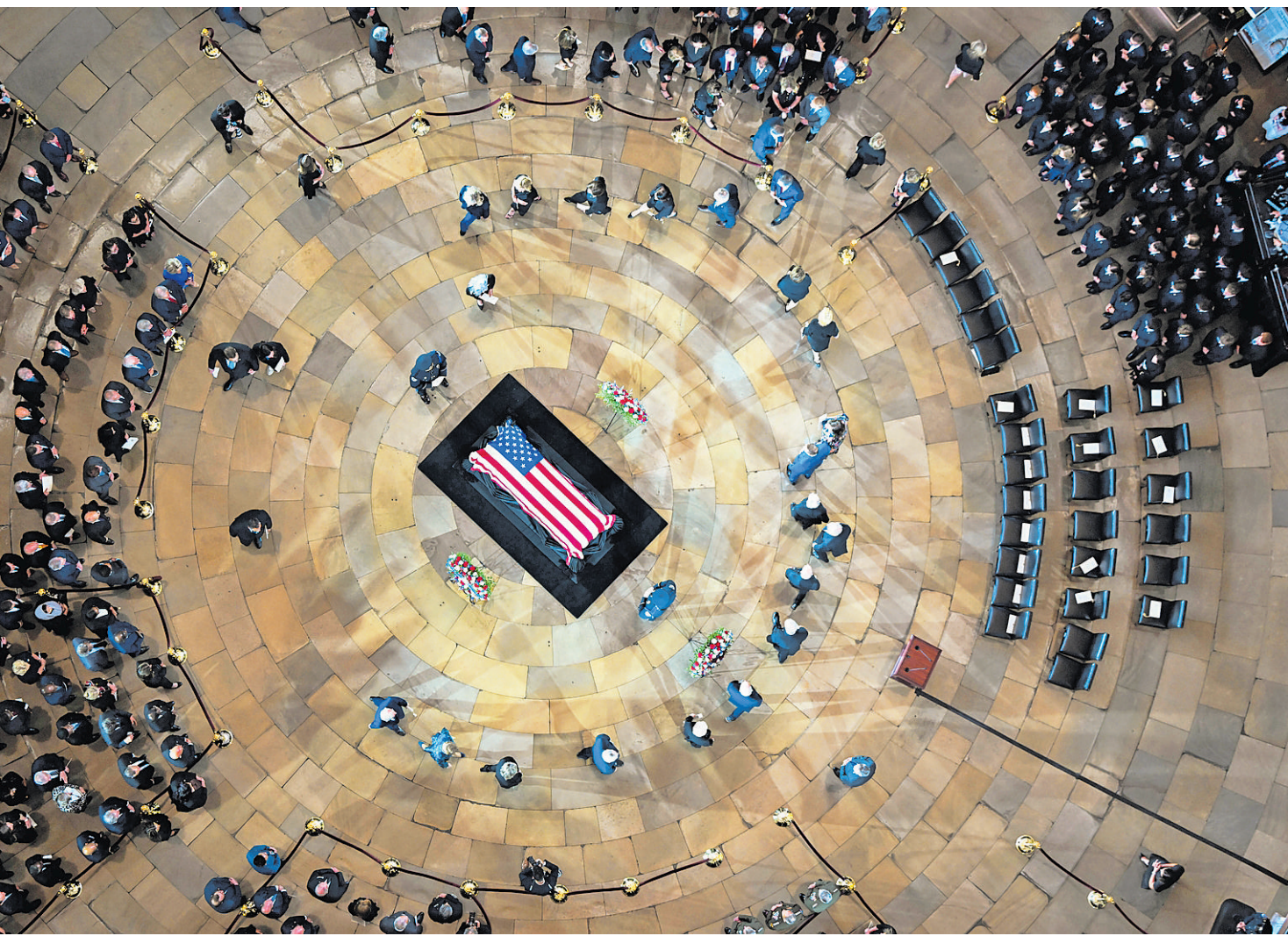
The pomp-and-circumstance farewell to Mr. Graham, the long-time Republican senator from South Carolina who died at 71 this month, showcased the current power structure. Until now, Mr. Trump had never been asked to deliver a eulogy for any of the presidents, senators and cabinet secretaries memorialized at the cathedral. But there he was on Tuesday in the iconic stone lectern extolling one of his most important converts in a city that has likewise had to accommodate itself.

“For more than 30 years, nothing of consequence happened in this capital without Lindsey Graham knowing about it,” Mr. Trump told a few thousand mourners. “Nothing of significance happened anywhere in the world without Lindsey Graham having a view on it. And no bill became law in the most exceptional republic in human history without Lindsey Graham having a say in it.”

It was that level of influence that appealed to Mr. Graham, who had once denounced Mr. Trump as a racist, xenophobic, ignorant, unqualified demagogue only to make himself into the president's closest ally on Capitol Hill. Neither Mr. McCain, a Republican senator from Arizona, nor Joseph I. Lieberman, a Democratic-turned-independent senator from Connecticut and the third of the amigos, could bring himself to accept Mr. Trump. But Mr. Graham did.

That was a theme of the recollections of Mr. Graham, whose political evolution alternately captivated and confused many of his old friends. So much so, in fact, that Sean Hannity, the Fox News evening host and conservative favorite who hosted the senator regularly,

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Senator Lindsey Graham's casket in the Capitol Rotunda on Tuesday. President Trump remembered him as a “giant” of the Senate.

U.S. Holds Up
Transit Grants
Worth Billions

**By EMILY BADGER
and ALICIA PARLAPIANO**

For decades, the federal government has funneled big-ticket grants to local communities to help them take on ambitious construction projects to expand public transit.

The grants, sometimes in the billions of dollars, have funded new railroad tracks, train stations and roads rebuilt for modern bus service. Today, they're funding extensions of the Second Avenue Subway in New York and the Red Line in Chicago, as well as the Gateway Tunnel under the Hudson River and bus infrastructure in Indianapolis and San Antonio.

But since President Trump returned to office, the Federal Transit Administration has not signed a single new agreement under the program, known as Capital Investment Grants. Large projects ready to enter the final phase of the program's yearslong pipeline have stalled there. The administration also tried halting payments to the New York and Chicago projects, forcing courts to intervene.

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Meta's Secret Push to Sweeten
Megacenter Deal

**By ELI TAN
and MAUREEN FARRELL**

HOLLY RIDGE, La. — A Louisiana state legislative committee was about to consider a bill in April 2024 when Richard Nelson, then the state's revenue secretary, received an urgent message from Gov. Jeff Landry. Get the bill passed, the newly elected Republican governor told him, because they needed it for something else.

Mr. Nelson walked across a room in Baton Rouge's towering State Capitol to the bill's author, Chris Turner, a Republican state representative.

“Hey, we need to hijack your bill,” Mr. Nelson told Mr. Turner. “I can't really tell you what it's about. All I can tell you is that it's important.”

Mr. Turner agreed. The bill had started out as a tax rebate for fiber-optic equipment. But when it was voted on by the state House of Representatives less than two months later, it had become a tax rebate for equipment used in data centers.

Mr. Turner had helped land the largest development in Louisiana's history: a \$50 billion data center for the Silicon Valley giant Meta that planners say could cover about six square miles and use seven times as much energy as New Orleans.

Meta wanted the rebate to build its data center in Richland Parish, an impoverished farming community in Louisiana's northeast corner. The tech company also needed a secret deal done quickly, and state officials were eager to oblige.

Rewriting the bill was a critical part of a nine-month process that

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Tax and Power Pledges
for Six-Square-Mile
Louisiana Facility



KYODO, VIA REUTERS

Earthquake Hits Southwest Japan

The 6.8 magnitude quake struck near the city of Uto. Dozens were reported injured. Page A8.

Fallopian Tubes Could Be Key
To Preventing Ovarian Cancer

By GINA KOLATA

Kira Wynn will do almost anything to avoid ovarian cancer, which killed her mother.

“My mom thought she'd pulled a muscle in her side,” Ms. Wynn said. Her mother's doctor, she added, “told her to do physical therapy.”

As is often the case with ovarian cancer, Ms. Wynn's mother's disease was already at an advanced stage when she was diagnosed. She died 10 months later.

Genetic tests could not pinpoint a mutation that would reveal whether Ms. Wynn was at risk for ovarian cancer, too.

So Ms. Wynn, 37, had a consultation with Dr. Rebecca Stone, a gynecological oncologist at Johns Hopkins Medicine. What she heard was not what she expected.

“Ovarian cancer,” Dr. Stone told

Removing Them Cuts
Risk by 80 Percent

her, is a misnomer. Nearly all ovarian cancers — and nearly all fatal ovarian cancers — are actually cancers of the fallopian tubes. The 20 percent or so that start in the ovaries are different, Dr. Stone said, and usually can be cured.

Women who have their tubes — the gummy worm-shaped ducts that carry eggs from the ovaries to the uterus — removed reduce their chances of getting ovarian cancer by nearly 80 percent. It's a five-minute operation that can be done as part of nearly any abdominal surgery, including a hysterectomy, tubal ligation, gallbladder surgery and hernia repair.

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After Raucous ‘Takeover,’ California City Considers Line in Sand

By JILL COWAN

NEWPORT BEACH, Calif. — Dozens of Newport Beach residents lined up at a City Council meeting this month to deliver the same message: Leaders of the Southern California coastal enclave needed to prevent another fracas like the one that took place on July 4.

Thousands of young people had descended on the beaches of the

city's storied Balboa Peninsula, attracted by posts on TikTok and other social media. Many seemed intent on making trouble. They shot illegal fireworks in all directions, scuffled and even looted an upscale grocery store. More than 300 people were arrested on July 4 alone. Most of them were 25 or younger, and most were from out of state.

The mess was “a predictable consequence of a growing reputa-

Teen Event Spurs Push
to Curb Beach Access

tion that Newport Beach has become a place where bad behavior is tolerated,” Maureen Cotton, the president of a local community group, told the council members.

City leaders vowed to undertake a broader review of regula-

tions aimed at managing crowds on the beach. At its meeting on Tuesday, the City Council was set to discuss potential changes, including a youth curfew, expanding the city's definition of a public nuisance and restricting mass gatherings planned on social media.

The Independence Day rowdiness tapped into national anxieties about social-media-driven “teen takeovers” and other misbe-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Racing to Contain Wildfires

Rain and cooler temperatures aided firefighters in Spain and France, days before a heat wave is expected. Page A7

Trump-Zelensky Chemistry

The two presidents met at the White House amid indications of a thaw in their relationship. Page A6

NATIONAL A10-20

Progressive in a Purple State

How Abdul El-Sayed fares in Michigan's primary next week may offer a preview of the campaign for Democrats' 2028 presidential primaries. Page A10

Life in Prison for Georgia Teen

Colt Gray pleaded guilty to 55 charges stemming from the 2024 attack at his high school that killed four. Page A19

SPORTS B7-10

In the Midst of Cycling Majesty

Tadej Pogacar was in his greatest form during his relentless ride toward a fifth Tour de France title. Page B7



ARTS C1-6

Saying Goodbye to ‘The Chi’

Lena Waithe's acclaimed drama has ended. “I'm grateful that we're going out when people still care,” she said. Page C1

Life After Early Stardom

Conor Oberst discusses his struggles and the challenges of writing political music in the Trump era. Page C1

BUSINESS B1-6

Laying Bets on Drug Trials

Predating markets on Kalsi and Poly-market now let people wager money on drug approvals. Kalsi also plans to allow bets on clinical trial results. Some researchers are concerned. Page B1

A \$500 Billion Data Center

The chipmaking giant Nvidia is in talks with OpenAI to provide a \$250 billion financial backstop for the project, which would be among the largest deals of the A.I. boom. Page B1

OPINION A22-23

Bret Stephens

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FOOD D1-8

What the Colonel Left Behind

A house, a restaurant, a Bible and suspenders from Colonel Sanders, the Kentucky Fried Chicken founder, are among items up for auction. Page D8

